

Xiaomi Pad 6

Good tablet with few shortcomings

Xiaomi is back with another tablet with the Xiaomi Pad 6 comes with a “Do It Better” tagline with a focus on Entertainment, Productivity, and gaming. So is the Xiaomi Pad 6 worth the Rs 28,999 price tag? Is the tablet a considerable improvement over the predecessor? Let’s take a look:

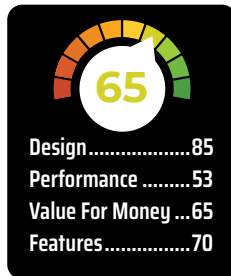
DESIGN

Design of the Xiaomi Pad 6 is very safe. It is in-line with the company’s new design language that places a square-ish camera module on the top corner of the back panel. The camera module design is very similar to the one we saw earlier this year on the Xiaomi 13 Pro, but here we only get a single camera. The back panel has a certain brushed aluminium finish, which gives the tablet a premium in-hand feel. Xiaomi has launched it in two colours - Graphite Grey and Mist Blue. We got the Graphite Grey for our review and as much as I hate to say it, the in-hand feel is very similar to the Apple iPad Air.

Up front also, the Xiaomi Pad 6 resembles the Apple iPad. The even bezels, along with the orientation, we can’t help but notice the similarities with the iPad. In fact, even the default wallpaper on the Xiaomi Pad 6 looks inspired by the Apple iPad Air. Now, this could work well for the brand since India is a market with a lot of aspirational buyers, and this could make for a poor man’s iPad in the near future, but at the same time, it shows lack of innovation and reliability on a tried and tested model.

Apart from this, an important design change here is that the Xiaomi Pad 6 has the front camera placed in the side bezel instead of the top, making it easier for the user to keep themselves in the center while taking video calls. Further, the Pogo Pins to attach accessories is also placed

₹26,999



on the back panel’s bottom right corner, which is a bit of a weird placement in terms of the overall scenario, but this doesn’t really matter since the accessories will be made with this orientation.

DISPLAY

The display quality on the Xiaomi Pad 6 is quite nice. The colours are vibrant and accurate, and the Dolby Vision support makes watching content on the device a pleasing experience. Since display is an integral part of all the three focus areas of the Xiaomi Pad 6 - Entertainment, Gaming and Productivity, the company has put in a lot of features in order to try and make this display stand out. For example, MEMC, which stands for Motion Estimation, Motion Correction. This technology works by forcing frames in the middle of two frames, which gives the display that extra level of smoothness.

In terms of colour accuracy, the Xiaomi Pad 6 display is pretty decent. We tested the display for colour accuracy using a Calman setup, and in sRGB colour profile, the Xiaomi Pad 6 showed a average DeltaE of 2.4, which is pretty good. The smartphone struggled to get the whites and browns right overall, but apart from

that, the Xiaomi Pad 6 showed pretty decent colour accuracy on our sRGB colour checker analysis. In the DCI-P3 colour checker analysis, the Xiaomi Pad 6 again showed an impressive average DeltaE of 2.5 and here also, the display only struggled in getting shades of white and brown right, along with similar results in the grayscale test, where the Pad 6 display uses too much blue to enhance the whites.

We also used a Lux Meter to measure the Xiaomi Pad 6’s maximum brightness, and the tablet showed a peak luminance of 623 nits, and a minimum brightness of 3 nits on a plain white screen. This is also a pretty good range for an IPS LCD display. I did use the tablet on a flight on a bright sunny day with the windows open, and while it was pretty good most of the times, there were moments or spots where the sun was shining too bright for me to see anything.

Furthermore, we also get a Video Toolbox feature that enables several video-specific features for any app you want to. On top of that, you can adjust the colour profiles on each app separately, and you can play around with the sound and Dolby Atmos settings separately on every app that you activate the feature for. There is also an HDR setting in the colour profiles, forcing HDR on non-HDR content across all apps that you have activated it for.

Now, while this could be good in the sense that it makes the picture appear more vibrant and bright, but it is a bit confusing since it takes a bit away from the creator’s intent, since non-HDR content is meant to be consumed in SDR, and HDR content is meant to be consumed in HDR. We did ask Xiaomi about how the brand aims to preserve the creator’s content here, but haven’t received a response yet. We will update this story as and when we get a response from the brand.

PERFORMANCE AND BATTERY

Coming to performance, the Xiaomi Pad 6 uses a Qualcomm Snapdragon 870 chipset, which was quite a popular chipset used for many performance or gaming-centric smartphones from last year. It is paired with 8GB of RAM, which should be enough for all kinds of tasks users will throw its way.